

Stick to the plan, not your mood

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Executive Summary

Pre-planning your actions eliminates emotional decision-making in the moment. When a plan is already written down, you follow it automatically — no negotiation with your mood required.

Contents

-  Core Principle: Plan Ahead, Not In the Moment
-  The Workout Example
-  The Fix: Write It Down

Core Principle: Plan Ahead, Not In the Moment [0:00](#)

- The central message: **stick to the plan, not your mood**
 - Decisions made in the moment are emotional decisions
 - Emotional decisions are unreliable — they bend to how you feel right now, not what you committed to

The Workout Example [0:00](#)

- Scenario: No workout scheduled in advance
 - Thursday morning arrives and you're a little tired, didn't sleep well
 - You wake up and make an emotional call: "I'm not in the mood to work out today"
 - Result: you take a rest day — not because you need it, but because you *feel* like it
- This is the danger of deciding on the fly
 - Fatigue and low mood become excuses that feel justified in the moment

The Fix: Write It Down [0:23](#)

- If the workout is already written into the plan (set at least a week ahead)
 - You wake up and there is no decision to make
 - No conscious deliberation, no emotional weighing
 - You simply follow what's already been decided

"I wake up and I can't even think. There's no consciousness, no emotion. I stick to the damn plan

and go work out."

- The key mechanism: removing the decision from the moment removes the mood from the equation
 - Pre-commitment beats willpower every time
 - The plan was made when you were clear-headed — trust that version of yourself